

Health, Safety, and Environmental Policy

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Approved By: Chief Operating Officer, HSE Director

Classification: Internal - Mandatory Compliance

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This policy establishes the health, safety, and environmental (HSE) standards for Meridian Holdings Group ("the Company"). The Company is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment, minimizing environmental impact, and complying with all applicable HSE laws and regulations.

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, contractors, visitors, and any other persons on Company premises
 - All Company operations, facilities, and work activities
 - All products and services provided by the Company
 - All environmental aspects of the Company's operations
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2. Health and Safety Management

2.1 Management Commitment

- a) Senior management is responsible for establishing and maintaining a safe working environment
- b) Adequate resources (financial, personnel, time) must be allocated for HSE activities
- c) HSE performance is included in management performance evaluations
- d) The HSE Director has direct access to the CEO and Board on HSE matters

2.2 Risk Assessment

- a) Workplace risk assessments must be conducted annually for all work areas and activities
- b) Risk assessments must be updated whenever there is a significant change in operations, equipment, or processes
- c) Job-specific risk assessments are required for hazardous activities
- d) Risk assessments must identify hazards, evaluate risks, and define control measures
- e) Residual risks must be communicated to affected personnel

2.3 Hazard Controls

Controls must be implemented following the hierarchy of controls:

1. Elimination: Remove the hazard entirely
 2. Substitution: Replace with a less hazardous alternative
 3. Engineering Controls: Isolate people from the hazard (guards, ventilation, barriers)
 4. Administrative Controls: Change work procedures, training, signage
 5. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): Last resort - provide appropriate PPE
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3. Workplace Safety Standards

3.1 General Workplace Safety

- a) All workplaces must comply with applicable building codes and occupational safety standards
- b) Emergency exits must be clearly marked, unobstructed, and accessible at all times
- c) Fire extinguishers must be inspected monthly and serviced annually
- d) First aid kits must be maintained and stocked in all work areas (minimum 1 per 50 employees)
- e) Trained first aiders must be available in all locations (minimum 1 per 100 employees)
- f) Workplace inspections must be conducted monthly by department safety representatives

3.2 Ergonomics

- a) Workstation assessments must be conducted for all office workers within 30 days of hire
- b) Ergonomic equipment (adjustable chairs, monitor stands, keyboard trays) must be provided
- c) Employees must take regular breaks from prolonged sitting or repetitive tasks
- d) Employees with musculoskeletal concerns must be referred for specialist ergonomic assessment

3.3 Electrical Safety

- a) All electrical installations must comply with applicable electrical codes
- b) Portable electrical equipment must be tested annually (PAT testing)

- c) Only qualified electricians may perform electrical work
- d) Employees must not modify electrical equipment or use damaged cables/connectors
- e) Extension cords must not be used as permanent wiring

3.4 Working at Height

- a) Working at height must be avoided where reasonably practicable
 - b) Where unavoidable, a working at height risk assessment must be completed
 - c) Fall protection equipment must be provided and inspected before each use
 - d) Scaffolding must be erected and inspected by competent persons
 - e) All personnel working at height must be trained and certified
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4. Emergency Preparedness

4.1 Emergency Plans

- a) Emergency response plans must be developed for all facilities
- b) Plans must cover fire, natural disasters, medical emergencies, chemical spills, active threats, and utility failures
- c) Emergency plans must be reviewed and updated annually
- d) Emergency contact information must be prominently displayed in all work areas

4.2 Fire Safety

- a) Fire risk assessments must be conducted annually by a qualified assessor
- b) Fire detection and suppression systems must be maintained and tested according to manufacturer specifications
- c) Fire drills must be conducted semi-annually for each facility
- d) Evacuation assembly points must be designated and communicated
- e) Fire wardens must be trained and appointed (minimum 1 per floor/zone)

4.3 Emergency Drills

- a) Full evacuation drills: Semi-annually
 - b) Shelter-in-place drills: Annually
 - c) Medical emergency drills: Annually
 - d) Drill results must be documented with lessons learned and improvement actions
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5. Incident Management

5.1 Incident Reporting

- a) All workplace incidents, accidents, near-misses, and occupational illnesses must be reported within 24 hours
- b) Serious incidents (fatality, hospitalization, amputation, loss of sight) must be reported immediately to the HSE Director and to regulatory authorities as required by law
- c) Incident reports must include date, time, location, persons involved, description of incident, injuries/damage, and immediate actions taken
- d) Anonymous reporting is available for safety concerns

5.2 Incident Investigation

- a) All incidents resulting in injury, illness, or significant property damage must be investigated
- b) Investigations must identify root causes, not just immediate causes
- c) Investigation reports must be completed within 10 business days
- d) Corrective actions must be identified, assigned, and tracked to completion
- e) Trends and patterns must be analyzed and addressed proactively

5.3 Workers' Compensation

- a) All work-related injuries and illnesses are covered by workers' compensation insurance
- b) Claims must be filed within 48 hours of the incident being reported
- c) The Company supports injured workers' return to work through modified duty programs
- d) Retaliation against employees who file workers' compensation claims is prohibited

6. Occupational Health

6.1 Health Monitoring

- a) Pre-employment health screenings are required for positions with specific health requirements
- b) Periodic health surveillance must be conducted for employees exposed to specific hazards (noise, chemicals, respiratory hazards)
- c) Mental health resources must be available through the Employee Assistance Program
- d) Fitness-for-duty evaluations may be required following extended illness or injury

6.2 Hazardous Materials

- a) An inventory of all hazardous materials must be maintained and updated quarterly
- b) Safety Data Sheets (SDS) must be accessible for all hazardous materials
- c) Employees handling hazardous materials must receive specific training
- d) Personal protective equipment must be provided and used as specified in the SDS
- e) Hazardous materials must be stored according to compatibility requirements
- f) Spill response procedures and equipment must be readily available

6.3 Communicable Disease Management

- a) The Company maintains a Pandemic Response Plan
 - b) Employees with communicable diseases must not report to the workplace until cleared by a medical professional
 - c) Reasonable accommodations will be provided for employees affected by communicable diseases
 - d) Enhanced hygiene and cleaning protocols may be activated during outbreaks
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7. Environmental Management

7.1 Environmental Commitments

The Company is committed to:

- a) Minimizing environmental impact across all operations
- b) Complying with all applicable environmental laws and regulations
- c) Continuous improvement of environmental performance
- d) Preventing pollution at source wherever practicable
- e) Setting and reviewing environmental objectives and targets annually

7.2 Emissions and Energy

- a) Greenhouse gas emissions must be measured and reported annually (Scope 1, 2, and material Scope 3)
- b) The Company targets a 30% reduction in Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 2030 from a 2020 baseline
- c) Energy efficiency must be considered in all procurement and operational decisions
- d) Renewable energy sources must be prioritized where economically feasible
- e) Energy audits must be conducted every 3 years for all major facilities

7.3 Waste Management

- a) Waste must be minimized through the hierarchy: Prevent, Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, Recover, Dispose
- b) Recycling programs must be implemented in all facilities

- c) Hazardous waste must be handled, stored, transported, and disposed of by licensed contractors
- d) Waste disposal documentation (manifests, certificates) must be maintained for 5 years
- e) Single-use plastics must be eliminated from Company operations where alternatives exist

7.4 Water Management

- a) Water consumption must be monitored and reported annually
- b) Water-efficient fixtures and equipment must be installed in all new and renovated facilities
- c) Wastewater must be treated to meet regulatory standards before discharge
- d) Water recycling systems should be considered for operations with significant water use

7.5 Environmental Incidents

- a) Environmental incidents (spills, releases, contamination) must be reported immediately to the HSE Director
- b) Regulatory notification requirements must be met (typically within 24 hours for reportable releases)
- c) Immediate containment and cleanup measures must be implemented
- d) Root cause investigation and corrective actions are required for all environmental incidents

8. Contractor Safety

8.1 Contractor Management

- a) All contractors must be pre-qualified based on HSE performance and capabilities
- b) Contractor HSE requirements must be included in all procurement contracts
- c) Contractors must provide evidence of insurance, training, and competency
- d) Contractor safety inductions must be conducted before work begins on Company premises
- e) Contractor work must be supervised and monitored by designated Company personnel

8.2 Permit to Work

High-risk activities require a Permit to Work:

- a) Hot work (welding, cutting, brazing)
- b) Confined space entry
- c) Electrical isolation and lockout/tagout
- d) Working at height above 2 meters
- e) Excavation and ground disturbance
- f) Work involving asbestos or other hazardous materials

Permits must be issued by authorized personnel, displayed at the work site, and returned upon completion.

9. Training and Competency

9.1 HSE Training

Training Type	Audience	Frequency
General HSE induction	All new employees/contractors	At hire
Fire safety and evacuation	All employees	Annual
First aid	Designated first aiders	Every 2 years
Hazardous materials handling	Affected employees	At assignment + annual
Working at height	Affected employees	At assignment + every 3 years
Environmental awareness	All employees	Annual
Incident investigation	Managers and safety reps	Every 2 years
Driver safety	Company vehicle users	Every 3 years

9.2 Competency Assurance

- Personnel performing safety-critical tasks must demonstrate competency through training, experience, and assessment
- Competency records must be maintained and reviewed annually
- Refresher training must be provided when competency gaps are identified

10. Performance Measurement

10.1 HSE Metrics

The Company tracks the following HSE performance indicators:

Leading Indicators:

- HSE training completion rate (target: 100%)
- Safety inspection completion rate (target: 100%)
- Near-miss reporting rate
- Corrective action closure rate

Lagging Indicators:

- Lost Time Injury Frequency Rate (LTIFR) - target: below industry average
- Total Recordable Incident Rate (TRIR)
- Environmental incidents

- Regulatory enforcement actions

10.2 Reporting

- a) Monthly HSE reports to senior management
 - b) Quarterly HSE reports to the Board
 - c) Annual HSE performance report (published)
 - d) Immediate notification for serious incidents
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11. Compliance and Enforcement

11.1 Regulatory Compliance

- a) The Company must comply with all applicable HSE laws and regulations
- b) A register of applicable HSE legislation must be maintained and reviewed quarterly
- c) Regulatory inspections and communications must be coordinated through the HSE Director
- d) Regulatory notices and fines must be reported to the COO and General Counsel immediately

11.2 Violations

- a) Safety violations may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination
- b) Willful disregard for safety rules may result in immediate dismissal
- c) Contractors who violate safety requirements may be removed from site and barred from future work
- d) The Company may be subject to regulatory fines and criminal prosecution for HSE violations

11.3 Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the HSE Director and approved by the COO. The policy is aligned with ISO 45001 (Occupational Health and Safety) and ISO 14001 (Environmental Management) standards.

Appendix A: Risk Assessment Template - See separate document POL-HSE-008-A

Appendix B: Incident Report Form - See separate document POL-HSE-008-B

Appendix C: Permit to Work Forms - See separate document POL-HSE-008-C

Appendix D: Emergency Response Plan Template - See separate document POL-HSE-008-D

Appendix E: Environmental Objectives and Targets - See separate document POL-HSE-008-E